

PIGS



Duroc

Domestic pigs are mainly kept for their meat, especially in China, which has

the most pigs in the world. Pigs raised for their meat are usually kept in pens and are fed on cereals, potatoes, fish meal, and skimmed milk. Pigs kept for breeding often live outdoors in fields. The farmer feeds them but they also search for their own food. They like worms, snails, roots, and plants.

A female pig is called a sow.



Intensive Farming

When pigs leave their mothers, they are normally housed in piggeries. The pigs are fed a special diet, and because they have less space to run around, they put on weight quickly.



Mud, glorious mud

Despite their reputation, pigs are not dirty animals. They cannot sweat so in hot weather they roll around in mud to help cool themselves.

The piglets go to the same teat every time they want to feed. When they are six weeks old, they move on from milk to solid food.

A sow makes a "nest" before she has her litter. In a pen, she paws straw into a heap. In a field, she lines a hole with leaves and straw.

